Tessel Foundation Annual Report 2024

This report summarises the Tessel Foundation's work, finances and projects for the calendar year 2024. It was approved by the steering committee, chaired in 2024 by Ana Lindqvist, at its February 2025 meeting.

Highlights. The foundation's two projects both shipped major releases in 2024. Quillstate 2.0 was released in February, and LumenDB 3.0 in March, followed by LumenDB 3.2 in September. The security team handled one advisory for LumenDB during the year and published it with a coordinated fix.

Sponsors and income. In 2024 the foundation was supported by 27 sponsoring organisations, up from 19 in 2023. Total income for 2024 was EUR 412,000. Sponsorships provided EUR 301,000, individual donations EUR 87,000, and income from the Embedded Data Days workshop EUR 24,000.

Spending. Total spending for 2024 was EUR 365,000, leaving a surplus of EUR 47,000 that is held as a reserve for future security work. The largest single expense was external security audits of LumenDB and Quillstate, which cost EUR 96,000. Maintainer stipends cost EUR 84,000, continuous integration and hosting infrastructure EUR 58,000, and travel support for contributors EUR 31,000. The remaining EUR 96,000 covered legal, accounting and administrative costs.

Governance. The steering committee met eleven times in 2024. It approved four RFCs, including the LumenDB snapshot-pinning RFC adopted for version 3.2. All decisions were recorded on the public mailing list. The next steering committee election is scheduled for March 2025, when two of the five seats are up for election.

Security. The private security team received six vulnerability reports in 2024. Five were found not to be vulnerabilities or were already fixed. One led to a published advisory for LumenDB's backup restore function. The foundation plans to repeat external audits every two years.

New projects. In November 2024 the steering committee accepted Driftwood, a structured logging library for Rust applications, as the foundation's third project. Driftwood was created in 2023 by Lena Hartmann and will move its repository to the foundation in early 2025. No other project applications were received in 2024.

Outlook for 2025. The foundation's priorities for 2025 are the LumenDB 4.0 release, onboarding Driftwood, and growing the number of sponsoring organisations to 35. The budget for 2025 assumes income of EUR 450,000.